

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Flexible Work Policy Change FAQ

Upon review of our hybrid work model, and after reviewing feedback from many of you, we are modifying our approach slightly, and we are doing this in a way to remain as flexible as possible. We have seen both the advantages of remote as well as in-person engagement and continue to strive to provide a supporting, collaborative environment at Relias, while also ensuring our leaders are supportive of you and are providing a caring, flexible work environment. At the same time, increasing use of the office for team meetings, company events, strategy sessions, 1:1s, etc., have shown us the advantages gained from in-person collaboration. For this reason, going forward, we have specific onsite requirements for local staff, those >50 miles away who live in NC, and those outside of NC (remote). Note: this policy does not apply to Relias Germany, which has its own hybrid work policy.

HOW MANY DAYS AM I REQUIRED TO BE IN THE OFFICE AS AN INDIVIDUAL CONTRIBUTOR?

If you live within 50 miles of the office (including small cities surrounding Fayetteville, Burlington, and Rocky Mount), you will be required to be in the building 30 days out of a quarter. If you are traveling for work, this also counts towards your 30 days. We still want to emphasize flexibility, so you can choose how long you want to be onsite and which days, outside of required meeting days as defined by your department and company events.

For those living outside of the 50-mile radius in NC and outside of NC, you will be required to come to the office at least 1x per year, but ideally visit the office 4x a year (once per quarter). If you would like to come more than this, please work with your manager on available travel and expense budget to ensure your expenses will be reimbursed.

WHY ARE WE MAKING THIS CHANGE NOW?

We've given ourselves a year to try different things and review how they have impacted not only our culture, but our business operations. We have continued to see better efficiency, collaboration, and teamwork both within and across departments when people have been onsite more. This is due to a variety of reasons:

1. In-person interaction promotes better collaboration and teamwork among employees. Being physically present in the office allows for spontaneous discussions, brainstorming sessions, and face-to-face interactions, fostering creativity, innovation, and effective problem-solving.

2. Being in the office enables employees to have direct and immediate communication with colleagues and managers. Face-to-face interactions facilitate clearer and more nuanced communication, reducing the chances of miscommunication and misunderstandings. Additionally, in-person interactions build stronger professional relationships, trust, and camaraderie among team members.
3. Being physically present in the office allows employees to benefit from mentorship and learning opportunities. More junior employees can better learn from more experienced colleagues and receive guidance, feedback, and support that may be more challenging to achieve remotely. This should contribute to their professional growth and development. Similarly, experienced colleagues can also be reverse mentored by our more junior employees, understanding more about new generations and technologies learned in school that drive better inclusion within Relias.
4. Office work can help reduce some mental health problems increasingly observed with remote work (such as isolation and loneliness, blurred work-life boundaries, increased stress and pressures, communication challenges, reduced social support, and increased risk of burnout)
5. Office environments facilitate informal knowledge sharing and learning opportunities. Unexpected conversations, impromptu meetings, and “watercooler” discussions can lead to the exchange of ideas, knowledge transfer, and informal learning experiences that may not occur as easily in a remote work setup.
6. Being physically present in the office can expedite decision-making and problem-solving processes. Quick and direct access to colleagues and decision-makers enables faster communication, consensus building, and resolution of issues, often leading to increased efficiency.

For our remote workers, we recognize that we will need to be mindful of maintaining inclusive practices as we bring staff back onsite more.

CAN MY MANAGER MAKE ME COME INTO THE OFFICE?

Yes, we are allowing managers to schedule mandatory events for local and remote staff. In these situations where travel is required, we are asking managers to provide a two-week notice to ensure airfare and other planning is considered. We do realize that employees may have personal situations that come up periodically that conflict with onsite events; however, we suggest you work with your manager if this situation occurs.

ARE MY EXPENSES COVERED IF I'M DRIVING IN FROM OUTSIDE OF THE 50 MILE RANGE OF THE OFFICE?

Yes, hotel, mileage, and daily per diem applies, per the travel and expense policy. Please be mindful that food and beverage charges only apply on overnight trips. Mileage should be calculated from your hometown to the 50-mile mark outside of the Raleigh-Durham metro area as this is fair to all others who drive in from the 50-mile radius of the office building. For more information about our travel and expense policy, please click [here](#).

AM I ABLE TO INCLUDE DRIVING TIME TO THE OFFICE AS TIME WORKED AS AN HOURLY WORKER?

In general, no. While employees may choose when to arrive and leave, commute time is not counted toward hours worked in the work week. Hourly employees should be clocked out for any time spent commuting. For salaried staff, if you are actively working during your commute time (e.g., on conference calls), this would be considered work time.

HOW DO I KNOW IF MY CITY IS OUTSIDE OF THE 50 MILE RADIUS?

Please check in UKG for your location assignment under Jobs>Other Company Information. Your status of Remote, HQ or >50M should be viewable here. In general, the following cities have been approved as outside of the 50 mile range of the office: Alexandria, Asheboro, Asheville, Avon, Bailey, Boone, Brevard, Charlotte, Concord, Davidson, Denver, Gastonia, Goldsboro, Greensboro, Greenville, Grifton, Hampstead, Henrico, High Point, Holly Ridge, Jacksonville, Kernersville, Lake Toxaway, Leland, Lexington, Littleton, Lumberton, Matthews, McLeansville, Merry Hill, Mint Hill, Monroe, Morganton, New Bern, Newport, Ocean Isle Beach, Rutherfordton, Salisbury, Shawboro, Spruce Pine, Statesville, Wilmington, Wilson, Winston-Salem, Wintersville, Yanceyville.

For those that live near the radius, your manager may request your presence in the office more frequently, especially in situations of people management. General reference map below:



CAN I MOVE WITHIN THE STATE OF NC (OUTSIDE OF THE 50 MILE RADIUS) WITHOUT ADVANCED APPROVAL?

No. Moving from within the Raleigh-Durham area would require Executive Team member and Chief People Officer approval. Many jobs at Relias are required to have onsite presence more frequently.

WHAT IF I WAS HIRED IN REMOTE STATUS PRIOR TO COVID AND LIVE IN THE STATE OF NC?

We changed all statuses for the state of NC to “local” during the last 24 months, even if you were hired as “remote” pre-COVID. This is because we changed our perspective on what is considered remote (i.e., everything outside of NC). Going forward, individuals with previous remote status in NC will either be “local” within 50 miles or >50 miles NC.

WILL NOT GOING INTO THE OFFICE IMPACT MY ABILITY TO BE PROMOTED GOING FORWARD?

We’d like to see individual contributors make a conscious effort to contribute to our onsite community at Relias. For this reason, while we will not be monitoring day-to-day employee onsite attendance, our leadership team will take this into account as we think about future opportunities at our company. Note that we will be concentrating on people leader roles in the Raleigh-Durham area going forward. In addition, this will be part of the consideration for various bonus awards.

WILL TAKING PTO COUNT AGAINST MY 30 DAYS A QUARTER?

No. We want staff to feel free to take PTO as they need to in order to stay fresh and engaged at work, so PTO days will be considered outside of the equation.

WILL I STILL BE ABLE TO EARN FREQUENT FLYER PRIZES?

We will be maintaining the ability to earn a permanent seat location (non-office) for individuals who are onsite 50 days per quarter.

WILL I REIMBURSED FOR CHILDCARE? PET CARE? GAS?

No. Over the last two years, we have moved all staff up in wages by 20-40% in addition to providing an annual increase/payment structure with COLA. This was all considered as part of the wage increase levels/pay bands in addition to the recent COLA increase.

It is also important to note that all staff should already be paying for childcare versus having children at home with you while you are working. During the pandemic, we provided some flexibility

WILL THERE BE ENOUGH SPACE WITH THESE NEW REQUIREMENTS?

Based on modeling within Office Space Software, we have enough seats in the bookable desks, library wings and the collaboration wings, in addition to the Café downstairs and in various meeting rooms. If we need more space, we can also rent additional space in our building that has come available until we can acquire more space permanently.

I'M CONCERNED ABOUT TRANSMISSABILITY OF VIRUSES/FLU SEASON. HOW SHOULD WE HANDLE THIS?

As always, we recommend that when people aren't feeling well to stay home. Employees should always feel comfortable to wear masks if they are concerned about immuno-compromised family members, as we have employees that do this currently. If there is a COVID exposure, we follow the procedural guidelines from the last year posted on Sharepoint.

We will continue to post new questions/answers ongoing as new broadly-focused questions are submitted.